

Capstone Project FAQs

Key Information

- Availability: 18th September 2026 12:00 AM.
- Submission deadline: 8th October 2026, 11.59 PM.
- Project type: Individual
- Submission: One ZIP file using the prescribed folder structure
- Marks: Report 30 + Programming 70
- Minimum model requirement: At least two LLMs

Schedule and Submission

1. When will the Capstone Project be available?

The Capstone Project will be available from 18th September 2026.

2. What is the Capstone Project submission deadline?

The submission deadline is 8th October 2026. Learners should follow the exact closing time displayed on the course portal.

3. Can I submit the project more than once before the deadline?

Yes. Multiple submissions are allowed before the deadline. Delete the old or incorrect file and upload the corrected file.

4. Which submission will be considered for evaluation?

The final file available in the portal after the submission deadline will be considered for evaluation.

5. Can I resubmit after the deadline?

No. Resubmission after the deadline will not be allowed. Carefully verify the final ZIP file before the deadline.

6. What should I do if I have further questions?

Post the query in the community chat or use the communicated support channel so that the team can address it.

Project Selection

7. Is the Capstone Project individual or group-based?

It is an individual project. Each learner must select and submit one project independently.

8. How many projects should I select?

Select any one project from the available project options. You do not need to complete multiple projects.

9. Do all project options carry equal weightage?

Yes. All project options carry equal weightage. Selecting a more difficult option does not automatically result in higher marks.

10. Can multiple learners select the same project?

Yes. Multiple learners may select the same project because each submission is individual.

11. How should I choose a project?

Choose the project that best matches your interest, background, available resources, and technical comfort.

12. How many project options are available?

Six project options are listed: CV Creation, CV Sorting, Advertisement Creator, Multimodal Medical Assistant, Sports Commentator from Video, and Text Puzzle Game Development.

13. What are the project IDs?

HPPCS01: CV Creation; HPPCS02: CV Sorting; HPPCS03: Advertisement Creator; HPPCS04: Multimodal Medical Assistant; HPPCS05: Sports Commentator from Video; HPPCS06: Text Puzzle Game Development.

Evaluation

14. Is a presentation required?

No. A presentation is not required.

15. How are the marks distributed?

The marks distribution is Report: 30 marks and Programming: 70 marks.

16. Will partial marks be awarded for incomplete code?

Yes. Partial marks may be awarded when the work is partially completed, provided the report accurately reflects and is in sync with the submitted code.

17. Is exact output matching required?

No. Evaluation is not limited to exact output matching. The approach, algorithms, implementation steps, report quality, code quality, and report-code consistency will also be considered.

18. What are the main evaluation criteria?

Evaluation considers the report, programming approach and algorithms, code comments and documentation, completion of the objective, and consistency between the report and code.

19. Will the report and code be evaluated together?

Yes. Consistency between the report and code is an evaluation criterion. Any mismatch may lead to mark deduction.

20. Will choosing a larger model receive more marks?

No. Model size alone does not determine marks. Select an appropriate model for the task and justify the selection clearly.

21. Will code modularity alone determine marks?

No. Proper modularity is recommended, but marks are primarily based on the approach, algorithms, implementation, and fulfillment of the project objective.

22. Will plagiarism checking be performed on the report?

The session did not confirm a specific plagiarism-check process. Learners should submit original work and properly cite or acknowledge external models, repositories, or assistance used.

Report

23. What is the maximum length of the report?

The report must not exceed 3 pages.

24. What font and spacing should be used?

Use Times New Roman, 12-point font, with 1.5 line spacing, following the supplied report template.

25. In which format should the final report be submitted?

Submit the final report in PDF format inside the Report folder. The DOCX working file will not be evaluated.

26. Can I change the report title and subheadings?

Yes. Titles and subheadings may be changed as needed, while keeping the report concise and within the required format and page limit.

27. Can I include images, screenshots, graphs, or diagrams in the report?

No. The formal instruction requires a text-only report and asks learners to avoid images.

28. What sections are suggested in the report?

The template includes Project Title, Abstract, Introduction, Problem Statement, Objectives, Methodology, System Design or Implementation, Results and Analysis, Conclusion and Future Work, References, and Acknowledgement.

29. How long should the abstract be?

The report template recommends an abstract of approximately 150 to 250 words.

30. Should I delete the notes section from the template?

Yes. Delete the Notes for Students section and all placeholder guidance before submission.

31. Are page numbers mandatory?

Page numbers in the footer are recommended to help track the 3-page limit, but the session stated that they are not mandatory.

32. Must the report accurately reflect the implementation?

Yes. The report must describe the models, approach, inputs, outputs, limitations, and implementation actually used in the submitted code.

33. Should model selection be justified in the report?

Yes. Explain why each model was chosen, including suitability, resource constraints, availability, and why alternatives were not selected where relevant.

34. Can I use generative AI to assist with report writing?

Yes. AI tools may be used to assist with writing or condensing the report, but the final report must accurately represent your own project and remain aligned with the code.

35. Are references and acknowledgements mandatory?

Include references or acknowledgements when applicable. Cite models, source code, repositories, or assistance used. If a section is not applicable, it may be removed.

Programming

36. Which programming language must be used?

The project must be implemented in Python. JavaScript-only or other-language-only submissions are not accepted.

37. Is `main.py` mandatory?

Yes. `main.py` must be the entry point. Code without `main.py` will not be evaluated.

38. What is `execution.txt`?

`execution.txt` contains the terminal command or commands needed to run the project, including required input, output, and parameter syntax.

39. Can `execution.txt` contain more than one command?

Yes. If the project requires multiple execution commands, list all required commands clearly in `execution.txt`.

40. Are code comments required?

Yes. Add clear comments for functions, classes, important logic, and other areas needed for evaluation and understanding. Note that proper comments in all python classes are a criteria for marking the programming part of the capstone.

41. Can I use multiple Python files?

Yes. You may use one or multiple Python files, provided `main.py` starts the program and all required files follow the prescribed submission structure.

42. Can I submit a Jupyter Notebook or `.ipynb` file?

No. Development may be done in notebooks, but the final submitted code must be in `.py` format.

43. Can I develop using Google Colab or Kaggle?

Yes. You may develop or test in Google Colab or Kaggle, but the final submission must contain the required Python files in the prescribed ZIP structure.

44. Is a graphical user interface required?

No. A front-end or browser-based GUI is not required. A command-line interface or terminal-based interaction is acceptable.

45. Can I create a GUI if I want to?

A UI is allowed by the written instruction, but the session recommended avoiding unnecessary browser-based GUI work because evaluation focuses on the core objective and submitted code.

46. Should I include library files or a virtual environment?

No. Do not include installed libraries, package folders, or virtual-environment files. Include only your source code and required project files.

Models and APIs

48. How many LLMs must be used?

Use at least two LLMs. More than two may be used if the project design genuinely requires them.

49. Can I use models other than those suggested in the project description?

Yes. Suggested models and packages are guidance only. You may use alternatives if they are appropriate, available, and properly justified.

50. Can I use paid, free, open-source, API-based, or local models?

Yes. Paid, free, open-source, API-based, and local models are allowed, provided the selected model is accessible for evaluation and its use is properly documented.

51. Should I include my API key in the submission?

No. Never include or hard-code an API key in the code or submitted files.

52. How should an API key be supplied to the program?

Pass the API key as a parameter to main.py, or document another secure runtime method such as an environment variable. Do not submit the key itself.

53. How will API-based code be evaluated if I do not share my key?

Evaluators will use their own available API key. Your execution instructions must clearly show how the key is supplied at runtime.

54. Can I use a privately fine-tuned model that evaluators cannot access?

Avoid models that are accessible only on your private system. The selected model should be available or reproducible for evaluation.

55. Should I always use the largest available model?

No. Use a model appropriate to the task and available resources. If a smaller model is selected because of CPU, GPU, memory, cost, or access limitations, explain the decision and any optimization used.

Files and Folder Structure

56. What is the required submission format?

Submit one ZIP file using the shared directory structure. The ZIP must contain the Report and Codebase folders with the required final files.

57. How should the main project folder be named?

Replace the ID placeholder in Capstone_Project-HPPCS[ID] with the selected project ID, for example Capstone_Project-HPPCS[01]. The session also indicated that a version without brackets is acceptable where brackets are not supported.

58. What should be placed in the Report folder?

Place the final report PDF in the Report folder. A simple filename such as report.pdf is recommended.

59. What should be placed in the Codebase folder?

Include main.py, execution.txt, and only the additional Python or other files genuinely required to execute the project.

60. Should I include the editable report.docx in the final submission?

No. The session advised removing report.docx before submission because only the final PDF is required for evaluation.

61. Should I include the instruction document in the final ZIP?

No. The session advised removing the instruction document because it is not required for evaluation.

62. Can I submit through GitHub or Google Drive?

No. GitHub, Google Drive, and other external-platform submissions are not accepted. Upload the ZIP file through the designated course submission area.

63. Should I include sample inputs, outputs, datasets, audio, video, or PDFs?

Do not include unnecessary input, output, dataset, media, or personal files. Evaluators will use appropriate test files. Include only files that are essential for the code to run and that comply with the formal project instructions.

64. Can I include subdirectories inside Codebase?

The formal instruction states that no subdirectories are allowed and files should be accessible from the same directory using ./ . Follow the formal instructions when preparing the final submission.

65. Is there a recommended ZIP size?

The session recommended keeping the submission compact, approximately 5 to 10 MB at most, by excluding datasets, models, libraries, virtual environments, and unnecessary files.

66. What should I check before uploading the ZIP?

Open the ZIP and verify the folder name and project ID, confirm report.pdf is in Report, confirm main.py and execution.txt are in Codebase, remove unnecessary files, and ensure no API keys or personal data are included.

Project Objectives

67. Must I follow every suggested step in the project description?

No. The steps are guidance. You may use an alternate logically correct approach that solves the stated objective.

68. Can I define my own input and output formats?

Yes, where the project objective allows flexibility. Clearly define the chosen input and output formats in the report and execution instructions, and ensure they support the stated objective.